Unit Rate

You have already learned how to find unit price. Unit price is an example of a **unit rate**. Unit rates are ratios that compare a quantity to one unit. Rates often use the word *per*, which means "for each."

Example 1

Hide

A clerk can type 270 words in 6 minutes. How many words per minute can the clerk type?

Step 1

Write a ratio.

$$\frac{270 \text{ words}}{6 \text{ minutes}}$$

GCF=6

$$\frac{270}{6} = \frac{45}{1} = 45$$

Step 2

Simplify to get a denominator of 1.

$$\frac{270}{6} \div \frac{6}{6} = \frac{45 \text{ words}}{1 \text{ minute}}$$

The clerk can type **45 words per minute.**

Unit rates are easy to compare. In math problems and in real-life situations, you may need to compare ratios. Changing the ratios to unit rates will help you judge which ratio is preferable.

Example 2

Hide

Two grocery stores are offering deals on bags of snack mix. Green's Grocer sells 3 large bags for $11.79. Conway's Co-op sells 5 large bags for $17.50. Which store offers a better deal?

Step 1

Write a ratio to represent the price per bag for each store.

Green's Grocer: $\frac{\$11.79}{3 \text{ bags}}$

Conway's Co-op: $\frac{\$17.50}{5 \text{ bags}}$

Step 2

Change the ratios to unit rates.

$\frac{\$11.79}{3} \div \frac{3}{3} = \frac{\$3.93}{1 \text{ bag}}$ $3.93 per bag

$\frac{\$17.50}{5} \div \frac{5}{5} = \frac{\$3.50}{1 \text{ bag}}$ $3.50 per bag

At $3.50 per bag, **Conway's Co-op** offers the better deal.

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Lesson 6: Ratios and Proportions

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